

PRIVATE TECHNIQUE BREAKDOWN · POINTE · TEEN (12-15)

Ava

"Gravity"

Elite extension and a flat split jump; the supporting side is next



Opening — tendu on pointe · 0:00 — lines and angles measured on Ava's own frame.

Coach's overview

I watched Ava's eight-second classical pointe phrase frame by frame: the opening tendu, the extension to the side that rises to nearly vertical, the balance on pointe with arms in a high V, the straddle jump, the landing, and the sous-sus finish. This is advanced, competition-level ballet. Her right leg reaches 173.9° from vertical (frame 5). Her split jump shows both legs above the hip line at the top (frame 17). Her feet are fully pointed in every airborne and relevé frame.

Because her level is high, her points will come from the details a top panel separates on. Her supporting knee softens as the leg goes up, from 179.7° in frame 2 to 169.3° in frame 5. Her torso tips further off vertical as the leg climbs. Her eyes drop to the floor after the jump (frame 22). None of these are about flexibility or strength. They are about control and finishing, and they can all be trained in a hallway.

A note on the camera: it sits in front, so the jump and side-extension numbers are 2-D projections. The split and knee readings in the air may read lower than they really are. I say where that applies.

WHERE SHE IS TODAY

Advanced classical technique that would score in the high range at regional level. Her extension and jump already look like a top-tier dancer's, and the deductions come from the supporting leg, vertical posture under the high leg, and how she finishes after big skills.

WHERE THIS TAKES HER

With a locked supporting knee, a vertical spine under the extension, and eyes held up through landings, Ava's phrase reads as clean as it is impressive. That is the difference between a high score and a top overall placement.

TIMELINE

Three to four focused weeks for the supporting-leg and posture habits. The landing focus can change at her next rehearsal.

SEVEN THINGS THE JUDGES SCORE

Lines & extension



8.6

Her right leg reaches 173.9° from vertical with a 171.9° split (frame 5), and it holds near 172° on pointe in frame 7. To be excellent rather than very good, her supporting knee needs to stay straight while the leg is at the top.

Alignment & core



7.4

Torso lean grows from 10.3° (frame 2) to 13.1° (frame 5) as her leg rises, but drops to 5.7° in frame 7. That shows she can stay upright when she organizes for it. Supporting hip and knee give way together in frame 5.

Jumps



8.4

The straddle peaks with both legs above horizontal (117.5° and 114.7° from vertical, frame 17), torso near upright at -1.2°, and arms in a lifted V. Knee readings of 165.7° and 167.9° in the air should be checked from a side angle. The landing finishes on full extension (frame 20).

Turns & balance



7.6

No full turn is visible in these frames. The best evidence is frame 7, a high extension held on pointe with the supporting knee at 175.5° and torso lean only 5.7°, which shows real balance control.

Arms & port de bras



7.7

Arms are long and lifted in frame 7 (160.2° and 165.1°) and in the jump. During the extension the left arm drops and bends: 27.1° lift in frame 4, elbow 150° in frame 5. It stops matching the line her legs are making.

Feet & pointe work



8.6

The working foot is fully pointed at the top of every extension (frames 3–7) and both feet are finished in the jump (frame 17). Her sous-sus in frames 28–31 is tight and well over the box.

Presence



7.6

Calm, regal carriage, with the head turned to finish the épaulement (head-and-shoulder angle) in frames 28 and 31. The eyes go to the floor right after the jump (frame 22), and that is the moment the panel notices.

What is already scoring



Extension most dancers never reach

173.9° of leg lift with a 171.9° split in frame 5, still near 172° on pointe in frame 7. Judges score extension heavily in a classical piece, and hers is in the top bracket.



A straddle that flies flat

At the apex both legs sit above the hip line (117.5° and 114.7° from vertical), her torso is nearly upright at -1.2°, and her arms are lifted (149° and 144.7°). The jump looks effortless and suspended.



Balanced and upright on pointe at full height

In frame 7 she holds a 172° extension on pointe with only 5.7° of torso lean and the supporting knee at 175.5°. That shows the posture she needs everywhere else already exists in her body.



Finished feet throughout

The working foot is pointed at the top of every extension frame, and both feet are fully pointed in the air. She never gives away a cheap foot deduction.



Clean pointe finish

The sous-sus in frames 28 and 31 shows knees at 176.4° and 176.5°, legs closed tight, and the head turned with épaulement. It is a polished final picture.

Priorities, in order

1

Keep the supporting knee straight as the working leg goes to the top

Her standing knee reads 179.7° in frame 2, 173.5° in frame 4 and 169.3° in frame 5, so it softens in step with the leg rising. From the judges' table a soft standing leg shortens the whole vertical line and reads as reaching rather than controlling. The cause is effort: she pushes down through the supporting side to get the leg up, instead of lifting out of it.

Cue: "Standing leg grows taller as the high leg goes up."

2

Stay vertical under the extension

Torso lean climbs from 10.3° (frame 2) to 11° (frame 3), 12.9° (frame 4) and 13.1° (frame 5). Her supporting hip also opens, from 168.8° to 158.1°. She is trading spine for leg height. Frame 7 shows she can hold the same extension with only 5.7° of lean when she pulls up first, so this is a habit, not a limit.

Cue: "Ribs over hips, then the leg."

3

Keep the eyes up through the jump landing

Frame 20 finishes beautifully with arms lifted, but by frame 22 her head is down and her eyes are on the floor. A panel reads that as relief or self-checking. It costs presentation and performance points right after her most impressive skill.

Cue: "Land, then look at the back row."

4

Keep the working knee straight all the way up the battement

On the way up the right knee reads 161.3° (frame 3), and on the way down it reads 171.5° (frame 9). It is straight only at the top. A judge sees the whole path, not just the peak, and a bent knee on the way up looks like the leg is being thrown.

Cue: "Long knee the whole way up and down."

5

Keep the support-side arm alive during the extension

Her left arm sinks to 27.1° of lift (frame 4) and her left elbow bends to 150° (frame 5) while her legs make a perfect line. The upper body stops matching the lower body, and the shape looks less finished than her legs deserve.

Cue: "The arm holds the shape while the leg works."

Opening — tendu on pointe



Knees 178.6° and 179.3°: both legs fully pulled up from the first count. Torso lean is a gentle 5.4°, and her arms are low and soft (22.3° and 32.6°). It is a quiet, confident start that tells the panel this is a classical dancer.

WORKING

- Both knees fully straight
- Calm, upright posture from the first count

CHANGE

- Let the eyes find the audience before the first move rather than the floor line

knees 179° / 179°

torso lean 5°

shoulders 175° · hips 161°

Extension begins — leg at hip height

Right leg rising to the side at hip height,
balance on left



At 102.1° of lift her standing knee is still locked at 179.7°, the best supporting leg in the phrase. Torso lean is already 10.3°, though. The spine is starting to give way before the leg reaches its peak.

WORKING

- Supporting knee at 179.7°
- Working foot fully pointed

CHANGE

- Lift through the ribs here so the lean doesn't build as the leg climbs

leg lift 102°

split 107°

knees 180° / 172°

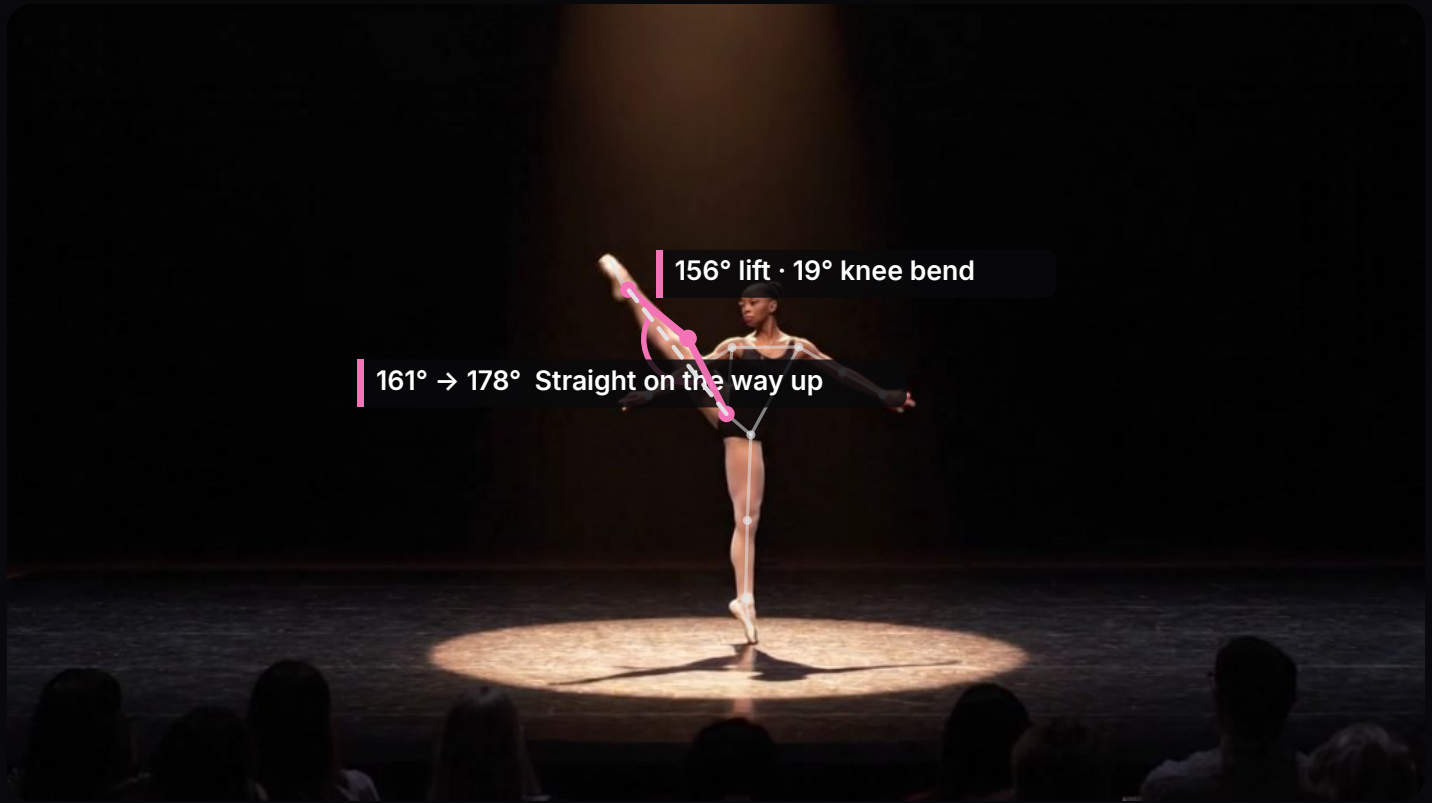
torso lean 10°

shoulders 178° · hips 128°

on the left leg

Passing through — working knee

Right leg passing 156° on the way up



The working knee reads 161.3°, so the leg is bending as it travels up. Torso lean has reached 11°. It is only a fraction of a second, but a panel sees it as the leg being thrown rather than lifted.

WORKING

- Supporting knee still straight at 179.4°
- Arms balanced at 44.8° and 44.4°

CHANGE

- Keep the back of the working knee long the whole way up
- Initiate from under the thigh, not a kick from the foot

leg lift 156°

split 157°

knees 179° / 161°

torso lean 11°

shoulders 179° · hips 123°

on the left leg

Nearly vertical — standing leg softens

Right leg at 171.1°, approaching the top



The leg is almost vertical, but the standing knee has dropped to 173.5° and torso lean is 12.9°. The left arm has sunk to 27.1° while the right sits at 43°, so the arms no longer match.

WORKING

- Working knee back to 174°
- Foot pointed at the top

CHANGE

- Re-lift the left arm to match the right
- Grow up through the standing leg

leg lift 171°

split 170°

knees 174° / 174°

torso lean 13°

shoulders 166° · hips 124°

on the left leg

Développé — the top of the line



Her best leg in the clip: 173.9° lift and a 171.9° split. The support side pays for it. The standing knee is 169.3°, the standing hip opens to 158.1°, torso lean is 13.1°, and the left elbow bends to 150°. Straighten the standing side and this same leg reads noticeably longer from the judges' table.

WORKING

- 173.9° extension, elite height
- Working leg straight at 174.3°

CHANGE

- Standing knee straight at the peak
- Spine back toward vertical
- Round, lifted left arm instead of a bent drop

leg lift 174°

split 172°

knees 169° / 174°

torso lean 13°

shoulders 166° · hips 119°

on the left leg

On pointe — the model frame

Extension held on pointe, arms in high V



This is the version to copy: leg still at 172°, torso lean down to 5.7°, standing knee 175.5°, and arms lifted to 160.2° and 165.1°. Pulling the arms up lifted her spine with them. Hip height is 0.50, the highest standing reading in the phrase.

WORKING

- Upright spine at 5.7°
- Long, matching arms
- High extension on pointe

CHANGE

- Close the last few degrees in the standing knee

leg lift 172°

split 169°

knees 176° / 177°

torso lean 6°

shoulders 177° · hips 132°

on the left leg

Lowering the leg

Right leg coming down through 142.6°



The descent is controlled and the arms open to second (79.9° and 103.2°). The working knee softens to 171.5° and the right elbow to 142.7°. Lowering the leg is judged the same as lifting it.

WORKING

- Controlled descent
- Torso back toward upright at 7.4°

CHANGE

- Hold the working knee straight on the way down
- Lengthen the right elbow

leg lift 143°

split 145°

knees 177° / 172°

torso lean 7°

shoulders 172° · hips 129°

on the left leg

Straddle rising

Split jump on the way up



Legs are already above horizontal at 116.8° and 112.2° from vertical, with the torso perfectly upright at -1.6° . The arms are lifted (138.5° and 134.2°) and the feet are pointed. It is a strong, organized take-off.

WORKING

- Upright torso
- Legs above hip line before the apex

CHANGE

- Check the knees on a side-angle video to see whether they're fully locked in the air

leg lift 117° split 136° knees $166^\circ / 165^\circ$ torso lean 2° shoulders 176° · hips 178°

on the right leg

Jump apex — suspended straddle

Straddle jump at its highest point



Both legs sit above the hip line (117.5° and 114.7°), hips are at their highest (0.55), and the torso is at -1.2° . Knees read 165.7° and 167.9° . From a front camera, turnout can shorten a knee reading, so confirm from the side. If they really are soft, locking them is the last detail on an already excellent jump.

WORKING

- Legs above horizontal
- Arms lifted and soft
- No forward lean at the top

CHANGE

- Squeeze the knees fully straight at the peak

leg lift 118° split 133° knees 166° / 168° torso lean 1° shoulders 175° · hips 178°

Landing into open relevé



Knees 177.8° and 179.1° , torso lean -1.5° , arms held at 117° and 113.9° . She lands, controls it, and keeps the upper body up. Technically this is a clean finish.

WORKING

- Straight legs on the finish
- Arms still lifted

CHANGE

- Keep the face up here; it's about to drop

knees 178° / 179°

torso lean 1°

shoulders 177° · hips 175°

Eyes to the floor

Settling in second after the jump



Legs are fine at 179.1° and 178.4° , but her head is down and her eyes are on the floor. Her arms have dropped to 49.8° and 54.8° . For a moment the dancer disappears, right after her biggest skill.

WORKING

- Square hips and shoulders

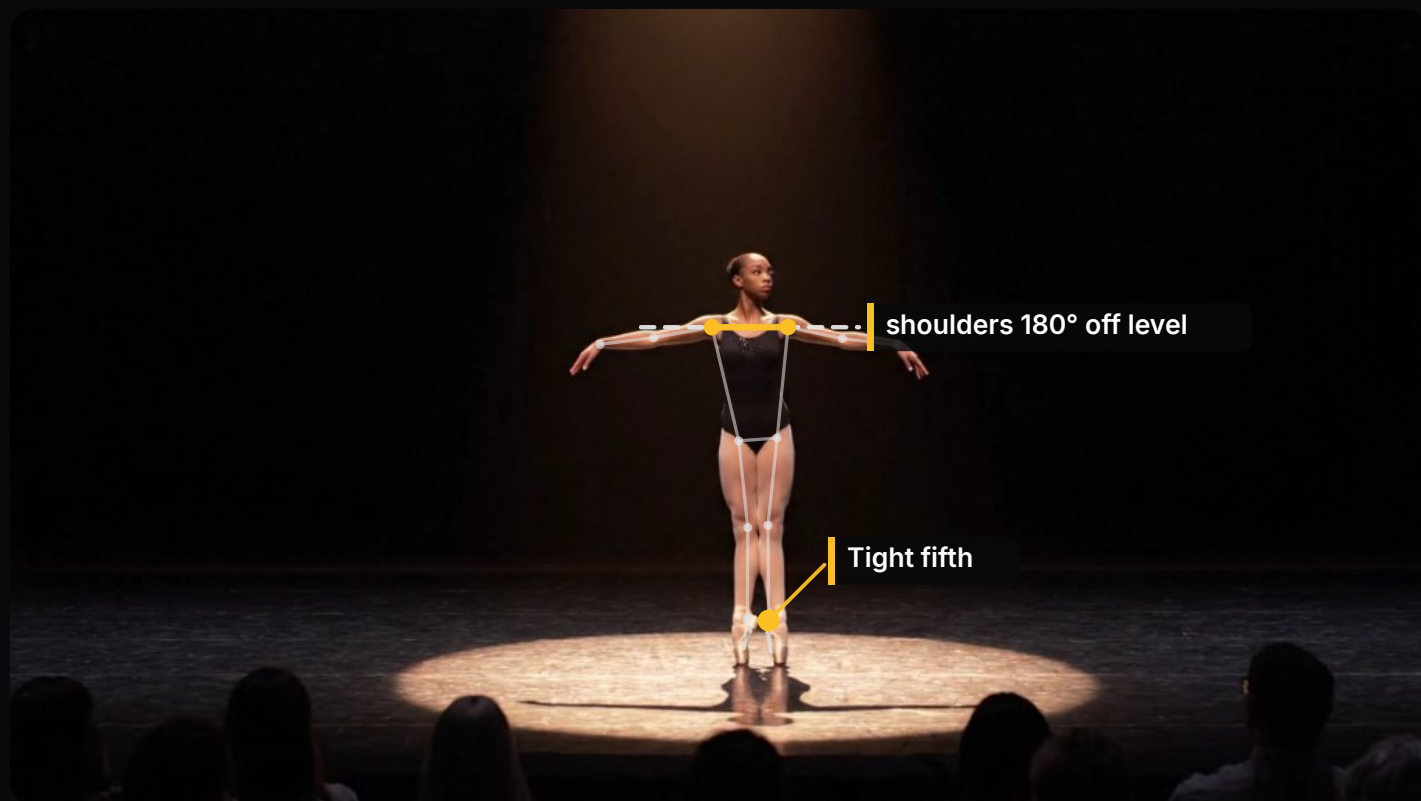
CHANGE

- Head and eyes up to the audience
- Carry the arms higher in the transition

knees 179° / 178° torso lean 2° shoulders 177° · hips 176°

Sous-sus with épaulement

Fifth on pointe, arms in second, head turned



A tight sous-sus: knees 176.4° and 176.5° , arms even at 73.7° and 74.7° , torso lean -2.3° , and the head turned to finish the shape. This is the classical polish a panel rewards.

WORKING

- Closed, crossed fifth on pointe
- Matched arms
- Head carries the épaulement

CHANGE

- Nothing major; keep the neck long

knees 176° / 177°

torso lean 2°

shoulders 180° · hips 173°

Final shape

Final pose in sous-sus



Legs and spine stay solid (torso lean -1°), but her arms have sunk from $73.7^\circ/74.7^\circ$ in frame 28 to $57.6^\circ/62.1^\circ$ here. The last picture is the one judges write their final score next to, so hold it at full size.

WORKING

- Steady on pointe to the end
- Focus held out to the side

CHANGE

- Keep the arms where they were in frame 28 until the music ends

knees $177^\circ / 176^\circ$ torso lean 1° shoulders 180° · hips 178°

Drills that fix the priorities

No equipment. Living room, hallway, or the studio before class. Each one is tied to a priority above.

1. Standing-leg wall lift

2 × 6 each side, 5 days a week

Targets: Priority 1: supporting knee

Stand sideways to a wall, inside hand lightly on it. Développé the outside leg to the side as high as she can control it. As the leg rises, press the floor away with the standing foot and think of the top of her head going up. Hold 4 counts, lower slowly, and check the standing knee never bends.

Cue: "Standing leg grows taller as the high leg goes up."

2. Back-to-wall développé

2 × 5 each side, 4 days a week

Targets: Priority 2: vertical spine

Stand with her back, shoulder blades and the back of her head touching a wall. Développé to the side or front only as high as she can go without her shoulders or head leaving the wall. Hold 3 counts, lower over 4.

Cue: "Ribs over hips, then the leg."

3. Straight-knee battement path

2 × 8 each side, 4 days a week

Targets: Priority 4: working knee

From fifth, do slow grand battements to the side over 4 counts up and 4 counts down. She keeps the back of the knee long the whole way and lifts from under the thigh instead of kicking from the foot. If the knee bends, lower the height.

Cue: "Long knee the whole way up and down."

4. Arm-anchor balance

3 × 8-count holds each side, 5 days a week

Targets: Priority 5: support-side arm

In retiré on demi-pointe, place her arms in second and hold 8 counts without letting either elbow drop or either arm sink. Then repeat with an extension in place of the retiré. A phone video from the front checks whether the arms match.

Cue: "The arm holds the shape while the leg works."

5. Land-and-look sautés

4 sets of 4, 4 days a week

Targets: Priority 3: eyes after landing

Do 4 sautés in first, finishing the last in a held relevé or demi-plié. On landing she picks one fixed spot at eye level across the room and holds her eyes there for 4 counts with the arms held. A parent or friend can call out if her eyes drop.

Cue: "Land, then look at the back row."

6. Straddle-hold knee lock

3 × 6 lifts, 4 days a week

Targets: Jump knees at the apex

Sit in a straddle on the floor with her back tall. Press the backs of the knees down, point the feet, and lift both heels an inch off the floor for 5 seconds. Release and repeat.

Cue: "Knees long, heels float."

How this reads on a judge's card

Competition sheets weight technique first, then performance, choreography, presentation and overall impression — and the judge talks into a mic while Ava dances. This is what that tape would say.

Technique 25 pts on the sheet	"Gorgeous extension, really up there. Watch that standing knee though, it's softening as the leg goes up."	21 ¹ / ₂₅
Execution & precision 15 pts on the sheet	"Lovely feet everywhere. Keep the working knee long on the way up and the way down, not just at the top."	11.9 ¹ / ₁₅
Performance quality 30 pts on the sheet	"Beautiful carriage on pointe. Don't look down after that jump, stay with us."	23.1 ¹ / ₃₀
Choreography & musicality 15 pts on the sheet	"Smart build from extension to jump to pointe finish. I want to see that balance in the high V really breathe on the music."	12 ¹ / ₁₅
Presentation 10 pts on the sheet	"Clean, classic look, hair and lines very polished. Hold those arms in the final pose, they're sinking."	8.2 ¹ / ₁₀
Overall impression 5 pts on the sheet	"Very talented technician. Finish every shape and this is a top score."	4.1 ¹ / ₅
Projected, one judge, 100-point sheet		80 ¹ / ₁₀₀

Weights follow the most common competition sheet (technique 40 · performance 30 · choreography 15 · presentation 10 · overall 5). Your circuit's card may split differently; the notes carry over.

FOR AVA

Next time on stage

Competition day, in order. Read it the night before, then once more in the hallway.

1 · WALK ON

Eyes up first

Before your first move, find a spot at the back of the room at eye level and breathe out once. Start from there, not from the floor.

2 · FIRST 8

Tall before the leg

Before the extension, lift your ribs and grow tall through the standing leg. Only then let the leg go up. Height comes after posture, not instead of it.

3 · THE HARD PART

Jump, then hold

Breathe in on the prep. In the air think 'knees long'. When you land, pick a face in the audience and keep looking at it for four counts.

4 · RECOVERY

Own the wobble

If a balance shifts, keep your face and arms exactly where they were and come down on purpose, like it was choreographed. Judges forgive a wobble way more than a panicked face.

5 · FINISH

Hold it longer

Keep your arms at full height in the final pose and count to four after the music stops before you relax.

6 · AFTER

One good, one next

When you walk off, name one thing that felt great and one thing for next time. Then let it go until the next rehearsal.

FOR THE PARENT

- In the car, lead with what she nailed: the height of her leg and that suspended straddle jump.
- Don't quote angles at her or point out every frame. Pick one cue a week from the priorities list.
- Ask her teacher to watch her standing knee and torso during extensions in class. That's the number-one fix.
- If you can, film the jump once from the side so her teacher can check whether her knees are fully straight in the air.
- Let the drills be her routine, not your checklist. Ten minutes a day beats an hour on the weekend.

Training plan

WEEK 1

Foundation: feel the straight standing leg and vertical spine

- Daily back-to-wall développé and standing-leg wall lift at moderate height
- Film one extension from the front at the end of the week and compare it with frame 5
- Land-and-look sautés every practice day

WEEK 2

Strength: hold the posture at higher leg heights

- Raise drill heights toward full extension while keeping the knee and spine checks
- Add the straight-knee battement path and the straddle-hold knee lock
- Arm-anchor balances in retiré, progressing to extension

WEEK 3

Integration: put it into the actual choreography

- Run only the extension section 5 times, focusing on the standing knee
- Run the jump-to-landing section with eyes up for 4 counts after each landing
- Film a full run; check frames like 5 and 22 against this report

WEEK 4

Performance: full runs under pressure

- Three full runs a session as if a panel were watching
- Hold the final pose at frame-28 arm height until a count of 4 after the music
- Walk through the onStage cues before each run

A NOTE FOR AVA

Ava, your leg goes higher than most dancers will ever get theirs, and your straddle looks like you're hanging in the air. What's left is the quiet stuff. Let the standing leg grow tall, stay over your hips while the leg goes up, and keep your eyes up after you land. Frame 7 shows you already know how. Now make every frame look like that one.

Coach

GLOSSARY

Développé — Unfolding the working leg slowly from the knee into a high, straight extension.

Supporting leg — The leg she is standing on. Judges watch that it stays fully straight.

Grand battement — A big, controlled kick of a straight leg, lifted and lowered with control.

Sous-sus — A tight fifth position up on pointe, legs crossed and squeezed together.

Épaulement — The angle of head and shoulders that gives classical shapes their finish.

Relevé — Rising onto demi-pointe or full pointe.

Port de bras — The carriage and movement of the arms.

Second position — Feet apart to the side, or arms open out to the sides.

Straddle jump — A jump with both legs split out to the sides in the air.

How to read the numbers: every angle and line in this report is measured from the frames of this video using on-device pose tracking, projected from the camera's point of view. A different camera angle will read slightly differently; trends across moments matter more than any single degree. Frames the report doesn't use are deleted after it is built. Questions: reply to the email this came with.